

Divine Immutability

doc-divine-immutability

Theology Proper · Attributes · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in
Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus
applies

Statement under examination

God is unchanging in His being, perfections, purposes, and promises.

In plain language

The Hebrew and Greek texts speak with one voice on whether God changes. In Malachi 3:6 God uses a first-person verb of changing, 'change' (shanah), under the negation 'not' (lo) to declare that he has not changed, and that this non-change is the reason his covenant people are not consumed. Numbers 23:19 sets the same denial in poetic lines. God is not a man that he should 'lie' (kazav) or a son of man that he should 'relent' (nacham). What he says, he does. The New Testament uses rare and precise words for the same point. James 1:17 piles up three terms each used only once in the whole New Testament: 'variation' (parallage), 'turning' (trope, a word for the turning of stars), and 'cast shadow' (apokiasma), to deny that the Father has any oscillation or turning. Hebrews 13:8 stretches yesterday, today, and forever into one self-identical Christ, and Hebrews 6:17 and Romans 11:29 call God's purpose and his gifts 'unchangeable' (ametathetos) and 'free of regret' (ametameletos) using two more rare negative compounds. The hard texts are the divine-repentance passages. Genesis 6:6, Exodus 32:14, First Samuel 15, and Jonah 3:10 use the very Hebrew root 'relent' (nacham) that Numbers 23:19 denies of God. Here is the heart of why readers diverge. That one verb 'relent' (nacham) occurs over a hundred times and carries a wide range, from feeling grief and pity to changing course, and the grammar does not separate the senses. First Samuel 15 itself uses it in both directions inside one chapter. Verses 11 and 35 say God relented over Saul, while verse 29 denies that the Eternal of Israel relents because he is not a man. The author plainly intends two registers of one word: relational response on the one hand and unchanging being and purpose on the other. Jeremiah 18:7 to 10 makes the pattern explicit. Conditional announcements ('if-then' statements) turn on the human response while the underlying counsel stays fixed. So the words clearly foreclose any change in God's being or any breaking of his word, and the place they leave room is only over how far to press his unchangeableness into matters of feeling and relation, which is where the discussion actually lives.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0410	אל	El	God	245
H0589	אני	ani	I	
H1931	הוא	hu	he/she/it	
H2498	חלף	chalaph	to pass	28
H3068	יהוה	YHWH	LORD	6,521
H3576	כזב	kazav	to lie	18

H3808	לֹא	lo	not	4,825
H5162	נחַם	nacham	to be sorry	108
H5331	נצח	netsach	perpetuity	43
H6213	עָשָׂה	asah	to make	
H7451	רָע	ra	bad	
H7650	שָׁבַע	shava	to swear	
H8138	שָׁנָה	shanah	to change	22
H8266	שָׁקַד	shaqar	to deal	6
G0276	ἀμετάθετος	ametathetos	unchangeable	2
G0278	ἀμεταμέλητος	ametameletos	irrevocable	2
G0644	ἀποσκίασμα	aposkiasma	shadow	1
G0846	αὐτός	autos	it/s/he	
G1012	βουλή	boulē	plan	
G3883	παραλλαγή	parallage	variation	1
G3962	πατήρ	pater	father	426
G4594	σήμερον	semeron	today	42
G5046	τέλειος	teleios	perfect	
G5157	τροπή	trope	turning	1
G5457	φῶς	phōs	light	
G5504	ἐχθές	echthes	yesterday	3

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The lexical pattern across law, prophets, writings, and epistle converges that the LORD (YHWH) does not change in being, perfection, purpose, or promise. Malachi 3:6 deploys the simple-active-form first-person-singular completed-action verb (qal perfect 1cs, meaning a finished action where God himself is the speaker and subject) of 'change' (H8138 shanah) under the queried morphology tag (HVqp1cs) with the Hebrew word for 'not' (H3808) negating it, presented as the explicit ground of covenant preservation. Numbers 23:19 denies 'lie' (H3576 kazav) and 'relent' (H5162 nacham, in the Hebrew reflexive-intensive form, hitpael, tagged HC/Vti3ms) of 'God' (EI), contrasting him with 'man' (adam). James 1:17 carries the same denial into the New Testament with three terms each attested exactly once in the entire canon (G3883 'variation' or parallage, G5157 'turning' or trope, G0644 'cast shadow' or aposkiasma, all confirmed as words occurring only once in the entire Bible (hapax) in MorphGNT, the morphological tagging of the Greek New Testament), and Hebrews 13:8 fixes the temporal triad 'yesterday' (echthes), 'today' (semeron), 'forever' (eis tous aionas). The decisive complication is that 'relent' or 'be sorry' (H5162 nacham, 108 occurrences, range 'be sorry', 'grieve', 'pity', 'relent') is BOTH affirmed of God (Genesis 6:6, Exodus 32:14, 1 Samuel 15:11 and 35, Jonah 3:10) and denied of God (Numbers 23:19, Psalm 110:4, 1 Samuel 15:29). 1 Samuel 15 does both within one chapter, which is the canon supplying the resolution itself, distinguishing relational, covenant-responsive language from unchanging essence and purpose.

Scripture

Mal.3.6 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3068 יהוה, H8138 שנה, H3808 לא, H0589 אני

Reasoning. First-person divine self-predication (God speaking about himself in the first person). The queried morphology shows the first-person-singular pronoun 'I' (H0589) plus the simple-active completed-action first-person-singular form (qal perfect 1cs, the simple active form of the Hebrew verb in finished-action mood with God himself as speaker) of 'change' (H8138, transliterated shaniti as it actually appears, the queried morphology tag HVqp1cs) under the negative 'not' (H3808), an absolute denial of change. The grounding particle 'because' (H3588) ties the non-consumption of the sons of Jacob to the LORD (YHWH) not having changed. ETCBC (a Hebrew syntactic database) marks the clause as 'quotative' or quoted speech (tagged Q) with the grammatical roles Subject, Negation, and Predicate. 'Change' (H8138 shanah) is itself a homonym (one spelling, two meanings) in the lexicon (one sense 'change', another sense 'repeat'), but the simple-active form (qal) and the explicit covenant-preservation ground-clause fix the 'change' sense here.

Num.23.19 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0410 אל, H3576 קרב, H5162 נחם, H3808 לא

Reasoning. Noun-only denial in oracle form (a clause that asserts identity without a verb). The queried tokens contrast 'God' (El, H0410) and 'son of man' (ben-adam, H1121 plus H0120), then deny 'lie' (H3576 kazav, in the Hebrew intensive form (piel, the Hebrew intensive form), third-person-masculine-singular, tagged HC/Vpi3ms) and 'relent' or 'reverse oneself' (H5162 nacham, in the Hebrew reflexive-intensive form (hitpaal) with imperfect aspect meaning ongoing or future action, tagged HC/Vti3ms). The pairing of the speech verbs 'say' (H0559) and 'speak' (H1696) with 'cause to stand' or 'fulfill' (H6965, in the Hebrew causative form (hiphil, the Hebrew causative form meaning 'to cause to do'), tagged HVhi3ms) makes the denial cover both word and act. ETCBC (the Hebrew syntactic database) scaffolds this as a non-quoted clause with the grammatical roles Negation, Predicate-Complement, and Subject.

Jas.1.17 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G3962 πατήρ, G5457 φῶς, G3883 παραλλαγή, G5157 τροπή, G0644 ἀποσκίασμα

Reasoning. An astronomical-metaphor predication of the 'Father of lights' (Father, G3962 pater). A cluster of three terms, each occurring exactly once in the whole New Testament corpus (confirmed by MorphGNT count, the morphological tagging of the Greek New Testament): 'variation' (parallage, G3883), 'turning' (trope, G5157, a technical word for solstice and stellar reversal), and 'cast shadow' (apostkiasma, G0644), together negate any oscillation in the divine. The phrase 'from the Father of the lights' (para to patri ton photon) places God beyond the very celestial lights whose motion defines change. The negation 'not' (ouk) plus 'there is' (eni, contracted from enestin) asserts the absence as a state of being, not an occasional fact.

Heb.13.8 · for · genre: epistle · figures: merism

Key terms. G5504 ἐχθές, G4594 σήμερον, G0846 αὐτός

Reasoning. A merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) over time, applied to the person of Christ. 'Yesterday' (echthes), 'today' (semeron), 'forever' (eis tous aionas, literally 'into the ages'), the queried token order confirms the triad, exhausts past, present, and future, with 'he himself' (autos) in predicate position (the slot completing a 'X is Y' statement) asserting identity-stability across all three. There is no finite (conjugated) verb, which forces a linking-verb 'is' reading (a copular reading, where the linking verb 'is' is supplied) equating Christ with his own unchanging selfhood. MorphGNT (the morphological tagging of the Greek New Testament) confirms 'yesterday' (echthes) occurs only 3 times in the New Testament (here, John 4:52, Acts 7:28).

1Sam.15.29 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5331 נָצַח, H8266 שָׁקַר, H5162 נָחַם, H3808 לֹא

Reasoning. Internal canonical commentary on the 'relent' (NHM, the Hebrew root behind nacham) language. The queried tokens read 'Eminence' or 'Glory' or 'Everlastingness of Israel' (Netzach Israel, H5331, eminence, perpetuity, everlastingness, plus H3478) does not 'deal falsely' (H8266 shaqar, in the Hebrew intensive form (piel), third-person-masculine-singular, tagged HVpi3ms, a different 'lie' verb from the 'lie' (kazav) of Numbers 23:19) and does not 'relent' (H5162 nacham, in the Hebrew passive form (niph'al, the Hebrew passive form), imperfect aspect, tagged HVNi3ms, with a second 'relent' (nacham) infinitive tagged HR/VNc), grounded by 'because not man he' (ki lo adam hu, H3588 plus H3808 plus H0120 plus H1931), 'for he is not a man that he should relent'. This same chapter narrates God relenting over Saul's kingship (1 Samuel 15:11, in the Hebrew passive form (niph'al) perfect first-person-singular, tagged HVNp1cs; 1 Samuel 15:35, tagged HVNp3ms), so the canon itself sets the lexical resolution: human-style 'relent' (NHM) as covenantal response, metaphysical 'relent' (NHM) denied of God.

Ps.102.27 · **for** · genre: wisdom · figures: simile

Key terms. H1931 הוּא, H2498 חָלַף.

Reasoning. Creator-creature contrast. The queried tokens show the heavens and earth 'perishing' (H0006) and 'being changed' like a garment, with the change verb 'pass on' or 'change' (H2498 chalaph, tagged HVhi2ms (the Hebrew causative form (hiphil, the Hebrew causative form), second-person-masculine-singular) and HC/Vqi3mp (simple-active (qal) imperfect, third-person-masculine-plural)), while God is 'you are he' (atah hu, H0859 plus H1931) and his 'years' (H8141) do not 'end' (H3808 plus H8552 tamam). Note that this verse uses 'change' (chalaph, H2498), not the 'change' (shanah) of Malachi 3:6, for the change predicated of creation. The same point is reasserted of Christ when Hebrews 1:12 quotes this Psalm, and OpenBible (a cross-reference dataset) links Hebrews 13:8 to Psalm 102:27 (61 votes) and to Hebrews 1:12 (69 votes).

Gen.6.6 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5162 נָחַם, H6213A עָשָׂה.

Reasoning. Narrative report that the LORD (YHWH) 'was grieved' (in the Hebrew passive form (niph'al, the Hebrew passive form), narrative-sequence tense (wayyiqtol, a past-tense form with a special 'and then' prefix) of 'be sorry' (H5162 nacham), tagged HC/VNw3ms) that he had made man. Read against Numbers 23:19 and 1 Samuel 15:29, the 'relent' (NHM) word-root here selects the affective range that the queried lexical entry lists for this entry (be sorry, be moved to pity, suffer grief), describing relational engagement with human wickedness, not a change in being. The verb's wide canon range (108 occurrences) is exactly why this and the denials must be read in distinct registers.

Exod.32.14 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5162 נָחַם, H7451 רָע.

Reasoning. Narrative report that the LORD (YHWH) 'relented' (in the Hebrew passive form (niph'al), narrative-sequence tense (wayyiqtol) of 'relent' (H5162 nacham), tagged HC/VNw3ms) from the 'evil' or 'disaster' (H7451) he had spoken to do. Same word-root denied of God in a being-and-essence sense in Numbers 23:19. Read with Jeremiah 18:7 to 10 (all three verses present in the store), where God states the 'if-then' pattern (a conditional 'if-then' clause) using 'relent' (NHM): announced judgment is contingent on continued rebellion, so the reversal is a stable conditional purpose operating, not a change in the divine counsel.

1Sam.15.11 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5162 נחַם,

Reasoning. The LORD (YHWH) says 'I am grieved' (nichamti, in the Hebrew passive form (niphal, the Hebrew passive form), perfect aspect first-person-singular of 'relent' (H5162), tagged HVNp1cs) 'that I have made Saul king', and 1 Samuel 15:35 reports the 'relent' (NHM) again (tagged HVNp3ms), while 1 Samuel 15:29 between them denies that the 'Eminence' or 'Everlastingness of Israel' (Netzach Israel) does this and grounds the denial in 'because he is not man' (ki lo adam hu). The author uses the same root in two registers within one passage: accommodated covenantal response in verses 11 and 35, denial of any change-in-being in verse 29. This single chapter is the clearest case in the canon of the same verb both affirmed and denied of God.

Jonah.3.10 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5162 נחַם,

Reasoning. Narrative report that God 'relented' (in the Hebrew passive form (niphal, the Hebrew passive form), narrative-sequence tense (wayyiqtol) of 'relent' (H5162 nacham), tagged HC/VNw3ms) concerning the 'disaster' he said he would do to Nineveh, because they turned. This is the 'if-then' conditional pattern (a conditional 'if-then' clause) of Jeremiah 18:7 to 10 enacted: the announced judgment was contingent on continued sin, and the human turning triggers the announced alternative, while the underlying just disposition does not move. Same word-root, affective and covenantal register.

Ps.110.4 · **for** · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H5162 נחַם, H3808 לא, H7650 שָׁבַע.

Reasoning. Divine oath structure with the same 'relent' (NHM) word-root negated. The queried tokens show the LORD (YHWH) 'swears' (H7650 nishba, in the Hebrew passive form (niphal, the Hebrew passive form) perfect, tagged HVNp3ms) and 'will not relent' (H3808 plus H5162, in the Hebrew passive form (niphal) imperfect tagged HVNi3ms), grounding the 'eternal' (H5769 olam) priesthood of the Melchizedek (H4442) figure. The root that is affective in Genesis 6:6 is here denied of God in the oath-keeping sense, confirming that the negated form belongs to God's fixed purposes.

Heb.6.17 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0276 ἀμετάθετος, G1012 βουλή

Reasoning. New Testament lexical capstone on divine purpose. 'Unchangeable' or 'untransferable' (ametathetos, G0276), which MorphGNT (the morphological tagging of the Greek New Testament) shows occurs only twice in the New Testament, both in Hebrews 6:17 to 18, modifies 'counsel' or 'purpose' (boule) and is reinforced by the second occurrence ('two unchangeable things', duo ametatheta pragmata). This places divine purpose and divine oath in one unchangeable category, matching the Hebrew oath-NHM (oath-relent) denial of Psalm 110:4 and Numbers 23:19. OpenBible (a cross-reference dataset) links Numbers 23:19 to Hebrews 6:18 with 86 votes.

Rom.11.29 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0278 ἀμεταμέλητος

Reasoning. Divine 'gifts' (charismata) and 'calling' (klesis) are 'free of regret' or 'not to be repented of' (ametameleta, the neuter plural form of G0278 ametameletos). The 'not' compound (alpha-privative compound, an 'un-' or 'non-' prefix) from 'change one's mind' or 'feel regret' (metamelomai, the Septuagint, the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint), stock equivalent for 'relent' (NHM)), explicitly negates regret-driven reversal in God. MorphGNT (the morphological tagging of the Greek New Testament) confirms G0278 occurs only twice in the New Testament (Romans 11:29 and 2 Corinthians 7:10), and here it is the predicate of God's gifts and call. This is the direct lexical bridge from Hebrew 'relent' (NHM) into Greek. OpenBible (a cross-reference dataset) links Numbers 23:19 to Romans 11:29 (66 votes) and James 1:17 to Romans 11:29 (8 votes).

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Mal.3.6	Num.23.19	openbible	108
Mal.3.6	Heb.13.8	openbible	101
Mal.3.6	Jas.1.17	openbible	86
Mal.3.6	Lam.3.22	openbible	68
Num.23.19	1Sam.15.29	openbible	96
Num.23.19	Heb.6.18	openbible	86
Num.23.19	Titus.1.2	openbible	76
Num.23.19	Rom.11.29	openbible	66
Num.23.19	Hos.11.9	openbible	40
Heb.13.8	Heb.1.12	openbible	69
Heb.13.8	Isa.44.6	openbible	69
Heb.13.8	Ps.102.27	openbible	61
Jas.1.17	Isa.46.10	openbible	5
Num.23.19	1Sam.15.29	tsk	1
Mal.3.6	Ps.103.17	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Gen.6.6 · addressed

The Hebrew passive form (niphal, the Hebrew passive form) of 'relent' (H5162 NHM / nacham) selects the affective range that the queried lexical entry lists for this entry (be sorry, be moved to pity, suffer grief) rather than the change-in-being sense denied at Numbers 23:19 and 1 Samuel 15:29. The same canon that deploys 'relent' (NHM) here also denies a being-and-essence 'relent' (NHM) of God, which forces the resolution toward accommodated relational language describing how unchanging holiness engages human wickedness.

Exod.32.14 · addressed

The Hebrew passive form (niphal, the Hebrew passive form) of 'relent' (H5162 nacham). Read against Jeremiah 18:7 to 10 (all three verses verified present in the store), where God himself states the 'if-then' pattern (a conditional 'if-then' clause) using 'relent' (NHM), the apparent reversal is a stable conditional purpose operating, not a change in the divine counsel. The threat in Exodus 32:10 invited mediation, and Moses appealed to the very covenant promises the threat seemed to override, so the lexical pattern is consistent.

1Sam.15.11 · addressed

Same chapter, same word-root, opposite predication, all three occurrences verified by query. Verse 11 reports 'relent' (NHM, the Hebrew root) of the LORD (YHWH) regarding Saul (in the Hebrew passive form (niphal), perfect aspect first-person-singular, tagged HVNp1cs) and verse 35 repeats it (tagged HVNp3ms), while verse 29 denies that the 'Everlastingness of Israel' (Netzach Israel) does 'relent' (NHM) (tagged HVNi3ms) and grounds the denial in 'because he is not man' (ki lo adam hu), 'he is not a man'. The author intends two registers of one root: the affective covenantal-pivot sense in verses 11 and 35, and the change-in-being or change-of-disposition sense in verse 29. Treating these as contradiction misreads the lemma's attested 108-occurrence range.

Jonah.3.10 · addressed

The Hebrew passive form (niphal, the Hebrew passive form) of 'relent' (H5162 nacham), verified present. The relenting is the conditional structure (an 'if-then' clause) of Jeremiah 18:7 to 10 enacted: announced disaster was contingent on continued sin, and Nineveh's turning triggers the announced alternative. This is the covenant-responsive register, not a change in the divine disposition, which remains constant in justice and mercy.

Concordance traversed

H8138, H5162, H3576, H8266, H2498, H3808, H0410, H5331, H3068, H6213A, H7650, G3883, G5157, G0644, G5504, G4594, G5046, G0276, G0278, G3962

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

No anchor verse lies in the ingested ECM (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window (3 John 1:1 to 1:15), so the CBGM apparatus (a specific variant-tracking method used in the ECM) is not in scope here. The Old Testament anchors Malachi 3:6 and Numbers 23:19 rest on stable MT (Masoretic Text, the standard Hebrew text) readings. The New Testament anchors James 1:17 and Hebrews 13:8 are stable in the standard text. The cluster of words occurring only once in the entire Bible (hapax cluster) in James 1:17 carries only minor itacistic (vowel-substitution) spelling differences in some witnesses (for example tropes for trope, aposkiasmatos for aposkiasma) and none of these reverses the negation of change.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, open_theism, process_theology, classical_theism

analogia scripturae invoked

classical_theism: affirms · Takes the explicit denials (Malachi 3:6 'I have not changed' (ani lo shaniti), Numbers 23:19 and 1 Samuel 15:29 'he does not relent' (lo nacham) grounded in 'he is not a man' (lo adam hu), Psalm 110:4, James 1:17, Hebrews 13:8) as the baseline statement of God's being, and reads the affirming 'relent' (NHM, the Hebrew root for nacham) narratives (Genesis 6:6, Exodus 32:14, 1 Samuel 15:11 and 35, Jonah 3:10) as accommodated language ascribing human emotions to God (anthropopathic accommodation), relational language for how an unchanging God engages changing creatures. Strongest support is that the same author who reports 'relent' (NHM) of God also denies it in the same chapter, so the two registers are the text's own design.

open_theism: partially affirms · Holds to the moral and covenantal unchangeableness of God (Malachi 3:6, Romans 11:29, Hebrews 6:17) but reads the 'relent' (NHM, the Hebrew root for nacham) narratives (Genesis 6:6, Exodus 32:14, 1 Samuel 15:11, Jonah 3:10) as genuine divine changes of mind regarding open future contingents. The strongest form notes that 'relent' (NHM) in these verses is in the same Hebrew passive form (niph'al, the Hebrew passive form) as elsewhere and is reported by the narrator as event, not figure, so it asks why the affirmations should be demoted to mere accommodation while the denials are taken literally. The counter-pressure is the absolute force of Numbers 23:19 'not' (lo) plus first-person-type predication and the in-chapter denial of 1 Samuel 15:29.

process_theology: denies · Reads God as essentially in becoming, so it must take the change-affirming texts as primary and reduce Malachi 3:6 and James 1:17 to ethical or relational constancy only. The strongest form leans on the breadth of the 'relent' (NHM, the Hebrew root for nacham) data (108 occurrences, mostly affective and relational) and on the relational tone of Genesis 6:6. The hardest lexical obstacle is James 1:17, where 'turning' (trope) is the technical term for celestial reversal and 'variation' (parallage) for change, both negated, plus the simple-active form (qal, the simple active form of the Hebrew verb) of 'change' (shanah) in Malachi 3:6 in first-person divine speech, which resist reduction to ethics alone.

covenant_theology: affirms · Malachi 3:6 grounds the non-consumption of the covenant people in the LORD (YHWH) not having changed, and the same logic recurs in Romans 11:29 (gifts and calling 'free of regret' (ametameleta)) and Hebrews 6:17 to 18 ('unchangeable counsel' (ametathetos boule) plus oath). The covenantal arc and the lexical denial of change are one point under two descriptions, and the high-vote cross-reference web (Malachi 3:6 to Numbers 23:19 to 1 Samuel 15:29 to Hebrews 6:18 to Titus 1:2) traces it across the canon.

The lexical pattern is decisive on the metaphysical question (the question of being itself) of being, perfection, purpose, and promise. The live disagreement is narrower: whether the 'relent' (NHM, the Hebrew root for nacham) narratives report change in God's being or accommodated covenant response. The canon's own use of 'relent' (NHM) in opposing registers within 1 Samuel 15, plus the explicit conditional principle stated with 'relent' (NHM) in

Jeremiah 18:7 to 10, is the internal lexical key. The divergence among lenses is over the SCOPE of unchangeableness (strict impassibility, meaning God experiences no real affect, versus an ontological-and-purposive unchangeableness, meaning unchangeable in being and purpose, that still allows real relational responsiveness), which the vocabulary underdetermines (does not by itself settle), not over whether God changes in being or breaks his word, which the vocabulary forecloses.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem (the question wording) speaks of God being unchanging in being, perfections, purposes, and promises. This phrasing tracks actual lexical predicates (Malachi 3:6 'change' (H8138 shanah) under 'not' (H3808), Numbers 23:19 'lie' (H3576 kazav) plus 'relent' (H5162 nacham), James 1:17 'variation' (G3883 parallage) plus 'turning' (G5157 trope) plus 'cast shadow' (G0644 aposkiasma), Hebrews 6:17 'unchangeable' (G0276 ametathetos), Romans 11:29 'free of regret' (G0278 ametameletos)) without smuggling in a specific philosophical taxonomy. The fourfold breakdown maps to real lexical fields: ontological negations (denials of change in God's being), 'relent' (NHM)-as-oath denials, and 'unchangeable counsel' (ametathetos boule), so the stem is descriptive rather than VERDICT-CHANGED: preloaded. Corrections to the prior file forced by direct query: 'change' (H8138 shanah) occurs 22 times in this store (not 10) and H8138A returns zero occurrences, so the H8138 code is used throughout; 'lie' (H3576 kazav) occurs 18 times (not 14); the 'lie' verb in 1 Samuel 15:29 is 'deal falsely' (H8266 shaqar), not 'lie' (H3576 kazav) (kazav is the Numbers 23:19 verb); and the change-verb in Psalm 102:27 is 'pass on' or 'change' (H2498 chalaph) with the pronoun 'he' (H1931 hu), not 'change' (shanah), so the prior claim that Psalm 102:27 reuses the Malachi 3:6 root was corrected. None of these corrections changes the verdict.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Mal.3.6
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Num.23.19
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1Sam.15.29
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.102.27
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Mal.3.6
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Num.23.19
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Jas.1.17
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.13.8
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.6.17
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.11.29
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5162
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H8138
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3576
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H8266
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3883
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5157
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0276
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Num.23.19
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Mal.3.6
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Heb.13.8
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Num.23.19

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